

Travel & Expense Policy

Purpose and Scope

This Travel & Expense Policy establishes guidelines for planning, paying for and reporting business travel. Its purpose is to ensure that employees and contractors conduct travel in a cost-effective manner while complying with tax and audit requirements and receiving timely reimbursements for business-related expenses.

The policy applies to all employees, contractors and consultants who incur travel or entertainment costs on behalf of the company. It covers domestic and international travel and applies to expenses paid with corporate cards or out of pocket.

Pre-approval and Booking

Travel must be approved in advance. Employees should submit a travel request to their manager outlining the business purpose and estimated costs. Managers may approve travel up to their delegated authority; trips with estimated costs above the department head limit require department head or executive approval, as specified in the Approval Matrix.

Employees are expected to book travel through the company's preferred travel agency or online booking tool. Air travel should be booked in coach/economy class unless an exception is granted; upgrades to premium cabins are not reimbursable. Lodging should be mid-range business hotels within government or corporate per-diem rates. Rental cars should be compact or mid-size; employees should decline optional insurance because the company's insurance policy provides coverage.

Reimbursable Expenses

- Airfare booked at the lowest logical fare in coach class
- Ground transportation such as taxis, rideshare, public transit, or rental cars when cost-effective
- Hotel lodging at reasonable rates within company or government per-diem limits
- Meals and incidentals within daily allowances or per-diem rates (alcohol is not reimbursable)
- Conference registration fees, business-related phone and internet charges
- Laundry and dry cleaning on trips lasting more than five days

Non-reimbursable Expenses

- Personal travel expenses including leisure activities, sightseeing tours and in-room movies
- Costs for family or companions traveling with the employee
- First-class or business-class airfare and hotel room upgrades unless pre-approved for medical reasons
- Alcoholic beverages (unless part of an approved client entertainment activity)
- Traffic fines, parking tickets, airline club memberships and lost items

Expense Submission and Receipts

Expense reports must be submitted within ten business days after the trip or purchase. Receipts are required for airfare, lodging, conference registration and car rental expenses regardless of amount. For other expenses, receipts are required for amounts of \$75 or more. Receipts should show the date, vendor, amount, description of goods or services and payment method. Credit card statements or bank records may be used when a receipt is unavailable, but employees should use a missing-receipt affidavit only for small expenses.

For international trips, foreign currency charges should be converted to the company's reporting currency. Employees must include a copy of the currency conversion from a reputable source or note the conversion rate on the receipts. Receipts must not contain sensitive information such as full credit card numbers, banking details, or personal identification numbers.

Reimbursement Process

Once an expense report is complete with all required receipts and approvals, the finance team will process reimbursement within seven to ten business days. Reimbursements are made via payroll or direct deposit. Employees should retain copies of receipts and expense reports for at least three years for audit purposes.

Exceptions and Compliance

Exceptions to this policy require written justification and approval from the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) or their designee. Examples include lodging rates that exceed the daily limit because the conference hotel has a higher negotiated rate, or emergency situations where a higher cost is unavoidable. Requests for exceptions should be submitted at the time of travel authorization. Unapproved personal expenses or policy violations will not be reimbursed and may result in disciplinary action.